

Project Management Maturity Model (PMMM) Case Study and Comparison

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Introduction

The Project Management Maturity Model (PMMM) helps organizations evaluate how advanced their project management practices are. It has **five levels**, ranging from ad hoc practices to full optimization. We will apply this model to three cases:

- A Health Authority introducing care pathways but with no project management approach.
- NHS-UK (United Kingdom's National Health Service).
- PMU / NHA Punjab (Pakistan).

PMMM Levels

Level 1 – Ad hoc Project Management

Definition: Projects are handled informally with no standardized methods. Success depends on individuals.

Health Authority: Currently here – no overall approach and few staff with project management skills.

NHS-UK: Long past this stage.

PMU Punjab: Some projects may still show ad hoc traits, but the organization has moved beyond this stage.

Level 2 – Formal Application of Project Management

Definition: Basic project management processes are introduced. Staff receive training, and templates for scheduling, budgeting, and reporting are used.

Health Authority: Needs to begin here by training staff and introducing simple templates.

NHS-UK: Surpassed this stage long ago.

PMU Punjab: Solidly here – monitoring units, MIS systems, and some standardized processes exist.

Level 3 – Institutionalization of Project Management

Definition: Project management becomes part of the organizational culture. A Project Management Office (PMO) may be established.

Health Authority: A long-term target after Level 2 is achieved.

NHS-UK: Many Trusts are at this level, embedding PM in daily operations.

PMU Punjab: Some functions are entering this stage, but not consistently across the whole organization.

Level 4 – Management of the Project Management System

Definition: Project management is aligned with strategy. Performance metrics (time, cost, quality, outcomes) are tracked and lessons learned are shared.

Health Authority: Future target – track patient outcomes and align projects with healthcare strategy.

NHS-UK: Many large initiatives (e.g., digital transformation) are already here.

PMU Punjab: Not yet at this level. Stronger integration with strategy and performance measurement is needed.

Level 5 – Optimization of the Project Management System

Definition: Continuous improvement and benchmarking against best practices. Advanced tools and a culture of learning are in place.

Health Authority: Ultimate maturity stage.

NHS-UK: Some advanced programmes are close to this level, using dashboards, benchmarking, and continuous learning.

PMU Punjab: Far from this stage – requires cultural change, skills development, and technology upgrades.

Comparison Table

PMMM Level	Health Authority	NHS-UK	PMU / NHA Punjab
Level 1: Ad hoc	No overall approach, few PM skills	Long surpassed	Some projects may still show traits
Level 2: Formal Application	Needs staff training and templates	Surpassed long ago	Solidly here with monitoring units and MIS
Level 3: Institutionalization	Long-term goal	Many Trusts here	Some functions entering this stage
Level 4: Management	Future target	Many large initiatives here	Not yet achieved
Level 5: Optimization	Ultimate target	Some advanced programmes near this level	Far from this stage

Conclusion

In summary:

- The **Health Authority** is currently at Level 1, needing staff training and basic frameworks.
- **PMU / NHA Punjab** is between Level 2 and 3, showing progress but lacking full institutionalization.
- **NHS-UK** is between Level 3 and 4, with some parts close to Level 5.

This comparison highlights the journey from basic, ad hoc project management toward optimized, strategy-aligned systems.